A LEGACY THAT LASTS A LIFETIME



Daniel Kwei Ayitiah

11 July 1950 – 20 September 2026

Burial and Thanksgiving Service
Saturday, 24th October 2026

Daniel Kwei Ayitiah

11 JULY 1950 TO 20 SEPTEMBER 2026

A charge to keep I have,
A God to glorify,
A never-dying soul to save,
And fit it for the sky.
To serve the present age,
My calling to fulfill;
O may it all my powers engage
Do my Master's will!

Arm me with watchful [or jealous] care
As in Thy sight to live,
And now Thy servant, Lord, prepare
A strict account to give!
Help me to watch and pray,
And still on Thee rely,
O let me not my trust betray,
But press to realms on high.

PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH OF GHANA
CALVARY CONGREGATION, HAATSO.

PROGRAMME FOR THE BURIAL AND THANKGIVING SERVICE FOR THE LATE MR. DANIEL KWEI AYITIAH

ON SATURDAY, 24TH OCTOBER 2026

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OFFICIATING AGENTS:

Rt. Rev. Dr. Abraham Nana Opare Kwakye
Rev. Lt. Col. A.L.A. Hammond (Rtd)
Rev. Kwei Masoperh
Rev. Edwin Tetteh-Bio
Cat. James Amoyaw Ackonnor

PRE-BURIAL SERVICE

1	**Opening**	District Presbyters' Conference, Haatso
2	*Hymn*	**Special Program**
3	**Prayer**	District Presbyters' Conference, Haatso
4	**Bible Reading**	Isaiah 40:28-31(Calvary, Ga)
5	*Hymn*	**PH. 647(1-5)**
6	**Bible Reading**	Rev. 7:9-17 (Grace, Eng.)
7	*Hymn*	**PH-304(1-4)**
8	**Bible Reading**	2 Cor. 5:1-10 (Ascension, Twi)
9	*Hymn*	**PH. 786(1-3)**
10	**Bible Readings**	Romans 8:12-17,38-39 (Shalom, Twi)
11	*Hymn*	**PH. 308(1-3)**
12	**Bible Reading**	1 Tim. 1:12-17 (Prince of Peace, Eng.)
13	*Hymn*	**PH. 769(1-3)**
14	**Bible Reading**	Psalm 23 (Resurrection,Agbogba, Ga)
15	*Hymn*	**PH. 310(1-3)**
16	**Bible Reading**	Luke 23:39-43(Dominion, Twi)
17	*Hymn*	**PH. 329(1,2&5)**

18	**Bible Reading**	Psalm 127 (Emmaus, Ga)
19	*Hymn*	**PH. 620 (1-2)**
20	**Bible Reading**	John 11:17-27 (Pleasant Hill, English)
21	*Hymn*	**PH. 563(1-4)**
22	**Bible Reading**	Psalm 37:1-7 (United, Ga)
23	*Hymn*	**PH. 562 (1-2, 10)**
24	**Bible Reading**	Psalm 126 (Golf Hills, English)
25	*Hymn*	**PH. 502(1-3)**
26	**Bible Reading**	Psalm 90 (Calvary, Ga)
27	*Hymn*	**Hymn 545 (1-4)**
28	**Filing Past(Presbyters)**	Presbyters
29	**Closing Prayer**	District Presbyters' Conference
30	**Closing of Casket**	Family
31	*Hymn*	**PH. 777**

PART I AT 9:00 AM

1	**Salutation**	Rev. Minister
2	*Hymn*	**PH. 508 (1-3)**
3	**Prayer**	Rev. Minister
4	*Hymn*	**PH 545 (1-3)**
5	**Biography/Tribute**	(Biography and Tributes)
6	**Anthem/Song**	PH. 787 (1-3)
7	**Scripture Reading (John 14:15-21)**	Presbyter
8	*Hymn*	**PH. 555 (1-3)**
9	**Sermon / Apostles' Creed**	Rev. Minister
10	**Offertory**	Church Choir

11	**Thanksgiving Prayer**	Rev. Minister
12	**Christian Charity**	Singing Band
13	**Dedication of Offertory**	Catechist/Presbyter
14	**Announcements**	Presbyter/Family Member
15	*Closing Hymn*	**PH. 776 (1-3)**
16	**Benediction**	Rev. Minister
17	**Song**	Ebenezer
18	*Recessional Hymn*	**PH. 792**

PART II AT THE GRAVE SIDE

1	**Scripture Sentences**	Rev. Minister
2	*Hymn*	**PH.801(1-2)**
3	**Exhortation**	Rev. Minister
4	*Hymn*	**PH. 818 (1-2)**
5	**Committal / Prayer**	Rev. Minister
6	*Hymn*	**PH. 825 (1-2)**
7	**Vote of Thanks**	Family
8	*Closing Hymn*	**PH. 806 (1-3)**
9	**Benediction**	Minister

Funeral Service Hymns

HYMN 508

What God ordains is always good,
What He permits is best here.
My life He ordered best for me,
I shall be still before Him.
My God is good, He knows all things,
He'll be with me in all things,
I'll therefore leave all to Him.

What God ordains is always good,
He gives what is best for me.
In paths of righteousness, He guides,
Joyful He makes me always.
God's glory is, my heart's desire,
He'll soon end all my sufferings,
Safe I am in Him always.

What God ordains is always good,
Remember me, O Lord now.
Wonderful God, my Savior is,
Remedy from Him, potent.
He'll not forsake, His chosen ones,
I'll lean on Jesus always,
And claim His gracious mercies.

HYMN 545

Rock of Ages, cleft for me,
Let me hide myself in Thee.
Let the water and the blood,
From Thy riven side which flowed.
Be of sin the double cure,
Cleanse me from its guilt and power

Not the labors of my hands,
Can fulfill Thy Law's demand;
Could my zeal no respite know,
Could my tears for ever flow,
All for sin could not atone,
Thou must save, and Thou alone.

Nothing in my hand I bring,
Simply to Thy Cross I cling;
Naked, come to Thee for dress,
Helpless, look to Thee for grace;
Foul, I to the Fountain fly;
Wash me, Savior, or I die.

HYMN 787

All the Saints shall be with God,
In Him they have treasure great.
They shall be with Christ their Lord,
With Him they shall always live.

Some are leaving us today,
Others soon shall follow them,
But we do not ask to know,
Whether here is home for us?

If the Lord gives us a choice,
To be with Him now or wait,
Many would like to be here,
They shall mourn to leave this earth.

HYMN 555

The Lord God is my Shepherd,
In Him I nothing lack.
He feeds me, and He helps me,
He guides me through this life.
My soul He saved, from sin and hell,
He leads me on the Way to Heav'n.

He sets His eyes upon me,
When in death's vale I walk.
Then shall I fear no evil, For God is with me still.
Your rod and staff they comfort me,
You'll give your servant joy always.

Jehovah spreads a banquet,
A table He has set.
Before my foes, He'll bless me,
Great honor He shall give.
Goodness and mercy shall be mine,
Eternal joy I'll have in Him.

HYMN 776

I know not when death shall come to me,
The days are passing, death draws near.
All too soon, death comes, waiting
[for us,
Death finds me and it comes to me.
The Blood of Jesus covers me,
Therefore, I'll die, a righteous death.

Lord, let me know the end of my life,
What the measure of all my days.
My spirit I commit to Jesus,
Grant me to leave this world in death.
The Blood of Jesus covers me,
Therefore, I'll die, a righteous death.

Help me to seek the joys of Heaven,
Make bitter taste this life on earth.
When eyelids close and I sleep in
[death,
Open my eyes to see You Lord.
The Blood of Jesus covers me,
Therefore, I'll die, a righteous death.

HYMN 792

I must go, I must go,
I must go to be with Jesus.
When I see my Savior Jesus,
I shall praise Him and adore Him,
I shall stay close to His Throne.

Glorious Light, glorious Light,
Light that overcomes the darkness.
When shall I experience this Light,
Glorious Light that shines from Jesus,
All the Saints, shall see Your Love.

Glorious Jesus, glorious Jesus,
See the angels all adore Him.
Give me wings that I might fly there,
Fly to see this splendid beauty
Zion City, such great beauty.

GRAVE SIDE HYMNS

HYMN 801

Only in Jesus Christ I must die,
With gladness and in peace I'll sleep.
His Blood and righteousness shall
[clothe me,
I shall be like a bride prepared.
I shall be comforted in Christ,
I shall in Christ pass through this vale.

Only in Jesus Christ I must die
In His death my death shall be sweet.
He'll not leave me to die eternal,
His Blood has set me free from rot.
I shall be comforted in Christ,
I shall in Christ pass through this vale.

HYMN 818

This body we now bury here,
By faith we commit it to earth.
By faith we know that it shall rise,
It shall rise to eternity.

The body is of earth and dust,
To dust it must return again.
From dust it shall be raised to life,
When trumpet of the angel sounds.

The soul is with the Lord our God,
The God of light who loves us much.
The God that saved us from all sin,
Through Christ the Lord He saved us all.

HYMN 825

A living hope we all have in Christ,
Beyond the grave, there's hope.
The dead shall all be raised,
Be raised to life eternal,
Hallelujah, Hallelujah.

The flesh is buried and shall dust be,
But it shall rise again.
It is just like seed,
A seed of life we sow here;
It shall be raised, it shall be raised.

HYMN 806

Go Home, with Jesus Christ,
He protects you and guides.
And may His grace be with you
[ever more,
Go Home, with Jesus Christ.

Walk with Jesus, always,
He protects you and guides.
And may His grace be with you
[ever more,
Walk with Jesus always.

Biography of the Late Daniel Kwei Ayitiah

The Late Daniel Kwei Ayitiah was born on Tuesday, 11th July 1950, at Osu, Accra, to Mr. Joseph Armah Ayitiah and Mrs. Beatrice Naa Shika Ayitiah, both of Osu, Accra. He was the third of eight children born into a loving and caring family. Dan began his early education at St. Thomas Preparatory School before proceeding to Osu Salem Primary School, where he spent six years. He later continued his education at Labone Secondary School. As a young boy, Dan was known to be quiet, reserved and thoughtful.

The Ayitiah family home was always filled with children and visitors. His father, the late Joseph A. Ayitiah, was a generous and compassionate man who welcomed people and readily offered help to those in need. Growing up in such an environment of love, generosity and hospitality profoundly influenced Dan's character. He learnt from his father the importance of caring for others and extending kindness to everyone, regardless of their circumstances. These values remained with him throughout his life.

After completing his secondary education, Dan's father wished to send him abroad to further his studies. However, Dan had other plans. Having seen an advertisement inviting graduates who aspired to become managers to apply, Dan seized the opportunity. He sat for the required examination, passed successfully, and began his banking career with Barclays Bank of Ghana Ltd. on 22nd November 1971.

Above all, Dan was a man whose life was firmly anchored in his faith in God. He was a lover of the things of God and devoted considerable time to Bible study, prayer and singing hymns. His relationship with the Lord was not simply a part of his life; it was the foundation upon which he built his decisions, relationships and aspirations.

In the early 1970s, Dan worshipped at Osu Ebenezer Presbyterian Church and later fellowshipped with the Osu Christian Fellowship at Labone. During this period, he developed lasting friendships with fellow believers, including H.E. Nii Adjei, who would later honour him by serving as his best man at his wedding.

In 1976, Dan met Patricia, the woman who would become the love of his life. Their paths crossed at a meeting organized by Child Evangelism Fellowship, where they were being trained as Child Evangelists. What began as a shared interest in Christian service blossomed into a beautiful friendship and, eventually, a lifelong love. After approximately two years of courtship, Dan and Patricia married and embarked on a remarkable journey together. Their union was marked by 47 years of marriage and 50 years of friendship, companionship, shared dreams, victories, laughter and unwavering love. Like every enduring relationship, theirs had its share of challenges and setbacks, but they faced life's experiences together, celebrating their successes and supporting one another through difficult times. Their marriage was blessed with four wonderful children and, in time, eight grandchildren, who became a tremendous source of joy and fulfillment to Dan.

Dan's career in banking was marked by dedication, integrity and an unwavering commitment to his Christian principles. He believed that his work was not merely a means of earning a living but also an opportunity to serve God faithfully. He refused to allow money or personal gain to compromise his values. Dan served Barclays Bank of Ghana Ltd. for more than 30 years, holding various positions and working in different branches and regions across the country.

In January 2004, he resigned from his position as Manager of the Kwame Nkrumah Circle Branch in Accra to join his beloved wife in managing their school complex, The Light Academy, which they had established together in August 1998. This transition marked the beginning of another significant chapter in his life, one devoted to education, service and the nurturing of young minds.

Dan's commitment to Christian service continued to grow over the years. On 11th May 1997, he was elected and installed as an elder of the Haatso-Papao Presbyterian Church Congregation, a position in which he served for four years. His willingness to serve in the church reflected his deep love for God and his desire to contribute to the spiritual growth and well-being of the Christian community.

For Dan, faith was more than words or religious observances. It was a guiding principle that shaped his character, strengthened him during trials and influenced the way he treated others. His life demonstrated the importance of trusting God, maintaining one's integrity and remaining faithful even when circumstances were difficult.

The Light Academy became an important part of the legacy Dan and Patricia built together. Their work in education reflected their belief in the value of preparing children for the future and creating opportunities for the next generation. He insisted on offering some children meals free of charge, scholarships to orphans, single parents as well as brilliant but needy pupils, Dan's contribution to the school will remain an enduring reminder of his commitment to service, family and community development.

In his later years, Dan experienced a number of health challenges. On Sunday, 20th September 2026, at the age of 76, Dan was called to glory, surrounded by his beloved wife, their four children and two of his siblings. His passing marked the end of his earthly journey, but the values he lived by and the memories he created will continue to live in the hearts of those who knew and loved him.

Dan is survived by his beloved wife, Patricia; his four children; eight grandchildren; his siblings, family, cousins, and numerous friends and loved ones.

A LIFE REMEMBERED: A LEGACY THAT LASTS A LIFETIME

Ataa Kwei, yaa wo ojogbaa.....



Dan and Patricia at their wedding in 1979



Celebrating 25 years of marriage

Tributes

TRIBUTE BY HIS WIFE

Tribute to My Beloved Husband, Daniel Kwei Ayitiah

> *Consider it pure joy, my brothers and sisters, whenever you face trials of many kinds, because you know that the testing of your faith produces perseverance - James 1:2,3.*

Today, as I stand before family, friends, loved ones, and all those whose lives you touched, my heart is heavy. There is a pain that words cannot fully express. I still find myself asking, "Dan, is it true you have really left us?" Yet even in my sorrow, I cannot help but say, it is well, it is well with my soul. I thank God for the wonderful privilege of sharing my life with such an extraordinary man. For 47 years of marriage and almost fifty years of friendship, companionship, laughter, challenges, victories, and unwavering love, God gave you to me.

Dan and I met in 1976 at Morning Star School in Cantonments. We were both members of the Osu and Labone Scripture Union fellowship meeting at Morning Star School where we were being trained to become Child Evangelism teachers. Neither of us knew then that God was weaving the story of our lives together.

We courted for 2 years before celebrating our customary marriage on the 30th of April 1978, followed by our wedding on 6th January the following year. We were young, hopeful, and full of dreams. Looking back now, I thank God for every step of that journey. When I married a banker, I quickly learned that transfers would become part of our lives. Our honeymoon was spent in Tamale, and what wonderful memories we made there. Though you moved around due to the demands of your work, we still found a way to build our family in the Lord.

In November 1979, we welcomed our first child. By 1981, we already had two sons and we were living in Labone with my in-laws. Then in 1984, after you returned from a training course in the United Kingdom, you met your daughter for the first time. I still laugh when I remember your reaction. I thought we agreed that two children were enough he said, and there I was holding our beautiful baby girl. You jokingly accused me of tricking you. That became one of the many stories that brought laughter into our home for years. And what a

special bond you shared with your daughter. She was truly your friend, your companion, and your pride.

Though I was the only child of my mother, you never made me feel alone or lonely. You became my family, my companion, and my greatest source of support. You worked hard to provide for us even though I was a teacher at Ridge Church School and by God's grace, we never lacked anything. Through every season of our lives, you ensured that our home was filled with love, and care.

Life was not always easy. In 1990, we suffered a great loss when your beloved father passed away. It was a painful season, but as we comforted one another and leaned on God, He blessed us again with a son in 1991. Through both joy and sorrow, we always found strength together.

One thing I admired about you was the way you loved your family. When the children were young and your work took you away, you found unique ways to remain close to them. Whenever you were home, you would march into the kitchen and prepare stew with the children gathered around you. To this day, I can still see the smiles on their faces. You would use double the ingredients I intended to use, leaving me wondering what was left for the rest of the week. But those moments created memories that our children will cherish forever. And you would always say, “Dani eba hi le latsa baa tsa bo. Which literally means “Before things will get better, you will sweat.”

As a banker with Barclays Bank, now Absa, your work took you to Tamale, Kumasi, Elmina, Cape Coast, and eventually to the Circle Branch, where you retired. But banking was only one part of who you were.

We acquired our own property in Adentan in 1994 and we never looked back. Dan, you were teaching at the Barclays (now Absa) Staff Training School for some years and you believed deeply in education and in helping others discover their potential, and so when the opportunity arose to establish our own school, you were overjoyed. In 1998, together, we founded what would become one of the greatest passions of your life, The Light Academy.

The school was not just a business to you. It was our ministry. It was our mission. It was our way of shaping lives. You knew every child mattered and you loved the learners as though they were yours. You encouraged those who struggled and celebrated those who excelled. You even started an initiative that rewarded all B.E.C.E candidates who got 10 ones with GHS 1,000. You believed every child deserved a chance to become great, that is why the learners of the

Light Academy lovingly called you Grandpa Pat. Today, the learners, staff, parents, and entire school community mourn you deeply.

Dan, people came to you with every kind of problem. Family disagreements, educational concerns, marriage challenges, building projects, financial decisions and you helped them in diverse ways. Your kindness knew no boundaries. Young or old, rich or poor, friend or stranger, you listened. You always listened.

Over the years, we built more than a family and a school. We built a home, a community, and friendships that have lasted a lifetime. The fellowship group from Osu and Labone, the Navigators, our colleagues in the education sector, our many friends at home and abroad cannot believe you've finished your race.

In recent years, our lives became marked by hospital visits, medical appointments, and countless prayers. Long before 2016, we began regular check-ups, and from then on, our faith was tested many times. We travelled between hospitals in the United Kingdom where we were hosted by Mr and Solomon Mrs Tackie Oblie, Mr and Mrs Desmond Armah Ayitiah, and the United States at the residence of his brother Joe Black, Dr and Mrs Roberts, Mr and Mrs Daniel Acquah. Through it all, you remained remarkably strong.

I watched you endure pain with courage. I watched you fight. I watched you trust God even on the hardest days.

On Sunday, 20th September, while the healing and deliverance services were taking place live at the church, you were fighting for your life. Eventually, your strength gave way, and the Lord called you home. My heart broke. Not because I doubted God, but because I was losing the person who had walked beside me for most of my life, the person who had enveloped me with so much love and the person who had kept his vows to me. Dan we had dreams we had not yet fulfilled, plans we had not yet completed and conversations we had not yet finished.

Dan, who do I turn to now when there is a family matter to discuss? Who do I call when I need advice? Aww! Dan who will sit beside me when I'm worrying over something and tell me he will handle it? These are the questions that fill my heart today. Yet even in my grief, I find comfort. You did not leave me empty-handed. Together, God blessed us with four beautiful children. Through them, our family grew to include four more children by marriage. Then came our eight precious grandchildren. Today, by God's grace, we are surrounded by a family larger than we ever imagined.

Dan you have left your Trish, you have left your children, grandchildren and many loved ones. But you have left a legacy of love, faith and service. And because of the countless lives you touched, I know I am not alone. The Bible reminds us that whatever we do for the least among us, we do for the Lord. Dan, you lived that truth. You gave of yourself generously and you lifted others. My dear Dan, you persevered in trial and as James says in verse 12 of chapter 1, you're blessed for having stood the test and therefore you'll receive the crown of life. My husband, my friend, my confidant, my partner in life, thank you and may your gentle soul rest in perfect peace.

TRIBUTE BY CHILDREN

— Edwin



They say not all heroes wear capes, and my dad, Daniel Kwei Ayitiah, was the perfect proof of that. He was a man of quiet courage, tremendous integrity, and an immense heart. Through his decades of dedicated service as a banker, he showed us the value of discipline and hard work. But his greatest investment was always in his family.

Our journey together takes me back to our earliest days in Labone, moving through Asylum Down and Kotobabi, before finally settling into the home he built for us in Adenta in 1994. For 32 years, Adenta has been the backdrop of our family's story, a testament to his stability, vision, and the protective sanctuary he provided for all of us. I will never forget the immense joy and pride we felt back in 1984 when he returned home from his training in the United Kingdom.

A turning point I will always carry with me was his transfer to the Kumasi Prempeh II Street branch of Barclays Bank (now Absa) in 1994, right after I finished my BECE. It was during those demanding transitions that his profound wisdom anchored me. He would tell me, *'Dani ebaahi lɛ, latsa baasabɔ'*— reminding me that before things can become well, you must be willing to sweat and work hard. He didn't just speak those words; he lived them every single day.

Life tested us in April 2010 when he suffered a mild stroke. At the time, I was following in his footsteps, working in the banking sector myself. But seeing the man who had always been my fortress face such a challenge redefined my priorities. By October of that year, I made the decision to resign from the bank so I could be right by his side, to care for him just as he had protected and cared for me my entire life. Being close to him during that season was the greatest privilege, a chance to give back a fraction of the boundless devotion he always poured into us.

During that difficult season, the true strength of his 47-year marriage to my mother shone brighter than ever. Witnessing the way they anchored, sheltered, and loved each other through that storm was a masterclass in devotion. Mum stood by him with an unwavering, fierce loyalty, and Dad fought back with the quiet resilience he was always known for. They became each other's ultimate support system, proving that the vows they took were a lifelong, unshakeable covenant.

Dad, your departure leaves a void that can never be filled, but it also leaves a grand vision. I stand here today and make this solemn vow to you: I promise you that your legacy will live long. I will see to it that your dream of building the senior high school comes to full fruition. The passion you had for creating a sanctuary of learning and opportunity will not end with your rest. It will be built, it will thrive, and it will carry your name and your spirit forward for generations to come.

You didn't just teach me how to live; you showed me through your everyday actions what it truly means to live with honor and humility. You were my guide, my protector, and my hero. Though you have gone home to rest, the foundation you built and the unconditional love you poured into my life will guide my steps forever. Rest in perfect peace, Dad. You will always be my hero.

Tswa omanye tswa! Ataa Nyɔŋmɔ ni bɔwɔ kɛ kpoo jɔɔmɔ ashwie onye jiemɔ lɛ nɔ. Yaawɔ jogbaŋŋ, mi-Tsɛ. Yaawɔ jogbaŋŋ yɛ Kristo mli, aahuu kɛyashi wɔbaakpe ekoŋŋ.

(May the Almighty God pour His ultimate peace and blessings upon your departure. Rest well, my father. Sleep peacefully in Christ, until we meet again.)

— Ken

On 20 September 2026, we sat by Dad's bedside as God called him home. He looked as though he had simply fallen asleep. It was only when the doctor and

nurses confirmed that he had no pulse that I realised he was gone.



Dad was a problem solver. To him, every problem had a solution. He was a risk taker, and his way of doing things was sometimes unconventional. He was generous and always willing to help anyone he came into contact with.

Dad had a way of making each of us feel special. He would tell you something and say, "I haven't told anyone ooo. You are the only person I have spoken to." Yet we all knew he had spoken to the rest of us about the same thing. That was Dad, making each of us feel trusted and included.

He thought about everyone, often before himself. After his brain surgery, when he struggled to remember people's names and faces, one of the first questions he asked was, "Has Ken paid the teachers' salaries?" Even then, the welfare of his staff was on his mind.

Dad lived a life worth emulating. We will remember his kindness, his concern for others and the example he set for us. His dream of building the Senior High School will come to pass, God being our helper.

Rest peacefully, Dad.

— Shirley Ann



Daddy, Daa... where do I start, and where do I end?

How do I say goodbye to a father who meant the world to me? How do I put a lifetime of love, laughter, conversations, dreams and memories into a few words?

Daddy, you were my safe place, my adviser, my encourager and one of my greatest supporters. You were strong and tough, yet beneath that strength was the softest, most loving heart.

No matter how old I became, I was still your little girl that Daddy's girl.

Daddy can you hear me! Who will ask me "How is your business doing? Are you making money?" Indeed I will miss how interested you were in everything I did.

When I was making soap, you would even count the drums I produced. At the time, they seemed like little things. Today, I realize they were your way of saying, "My daughter, I am watching you. I believe in you. I want you to succeed."

Oh Daddy, what I would give to hear those questions one more time. Hello Daddy can you hear me?

I will miss your voice, your laughter, your advice and especially that mischievous smile. I will miss dreaming with you and telling you about my plans. There is still so much I want to tell you, so much I want to accomplish and come back to share with you.

You were a visionary father. You saw possibilities beyond today and planted dreams in us for tomorrow. And you were not only a father to your own children, you were a father to the fatherless and hope to the needy. Your love, guidance and generosity reached far beyond the Ayitiah family.

Even in your final moments, your thoughts were about the children.

Your last words to me were about them. You repeated them several times. I did not fully understand then, Daddy, but I understand now.

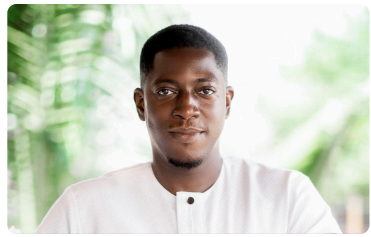
> I heard you, Daa.
> I promise you: I will take care of the children.
> I will carry your dreams.
> I will continue what you started.
> I will protect the family you loved so dearly.
> And by God's grace, I will make you proud.

My heart breaks knowing I will not see you sitting there, asking your questions and giving me that proud smile again.

> But I know one thing for certain:
> Your love did not die with you.
> It lives in me.
> It lives in your children.
> It lives in your grandchildren.
> And it lives in every life you touched.
> Daddy, I cannot say goodbye because you are too deeply woven into who I am.
> So instead, I will say:
> Thank you for loving me.
> Thank you for believing in me.

> Thank you for being my Daddy.
> A thousand kisses to you in heaven, Daa.
> Rest peacefully, Daddy.
> Your Daddy's girl loves you more than words could ever say.
> Daddy Until we meet again
> Yaa wɔ jogbaa

— Nii Armah



The day I feared would come is here. I remember weekends when you returned from Cape Coast, you would take me along almost every Saturday when you went to town. I remember riding with you to Tema, to Osu, to visit people. I remember you asked me to follow you to bible studies at Prof Wellingtons house, with Prof Appeaning Addo and Rev Dr Nortey, usually just us and the wonderful times we had sharing the word, preparing for bible studies. Those were some of the most memorable times of my life.

Many people wondered why I stopped leading bible studies in church, well it was because of you. When you fell ill after COVID, not seeing you in the pews with me was tough. I was not doing it to impress you but I loved it when you were seated and your support and advice afterwards made doing it worthwhile.

You told me how you did not reach a certain height in your career because you felt God was calling you into the ministry so you were pursuing that instead of the training courses. That was how much you loved the Lord and not wanting to miss His leading. Your dedication to the things of God and your service even in this congregation was mindblowing. I remember you over the years working tirelessly to raise funds for the church building, moving from the classroom to the other halls to this current auditorium. You have paid your due to this church and I believe your reward is with Yahweh.

A charge to keep I have, a God to glorify. I promise Daa on this day to honor those words in this song, the advice you used to give me.

You are a man of vision, a man that had a plan. You had many unfinished plans. We will carry that torch and bring your dreams to life.

You opened doors for me and did everything you could to make life easy.

You touched many lives. You impacted many people even more than I ever imagined. You were not everyone's cup of tea but you were my perfect father. You did Fatherhood the best way you knew and I thank you for being ever present, available. You were simply the best. I will take the lessons you taught me to become a better man, a better Father and a blessing to many others like you. I thank God for giving me you - the best Ayitiah. I have been blessed immensely by God.

I thank God for all the wonderful friends who have walked with you over the years and genuinely did care about you.

I will miss trying to kiss you- something you did not like but I did it regardless.

I miss sitting outside on the porch with you just talking about your many experiences, stories and ideas. You never for once stopped caring even when you were in pain.

I will miss watching football with you. I will miss supporting Manchester United with you. They are rubbish now anyways so I am even considering retiring from supporting them.

You are definitely in a better place. I know we will meet again soon. I thank God for giving us you. I thank you for teaching my siblings and I to be together and united something you never had with your own.

Every night, we prayed for you. Nii and Naa prayed: Father make Grandpa strong and heal him. We thank God He decided to do even better and bring you to Himself. I told them you are with Jesus, but somehow they still mention you in their prayers. We love you and will always love you.

I could not bear to see you sick any longer. I will miss you. I have cried and I will not stop. I really do. Thank you for seeing the best in me even when I doubted myself and for always encouraging and supporting me.

> What the enemy has meant for evil, God has turned for our good.
> What the enemy has meant for evil, God has turned for our good.
> What the enemy has meant for evil, God has turned for our good.

— Dorothy



Daddy, I've accepted there will be no one to buy my Christmas cloth again. I'll miss being the one you called to sneak food for you at family gatherings, our prayer times where you always led the Word, our praise and dance to "David mantse mpo eteshie," and our movie time together.

I still remember your face when I told you your grandson would walk to school. You were loving, caring, and gave your all for family. We will miss your advice, your cakes, and your

grilled chicken in wine delicacies.

Thank you for our time together. It was good knowing you. God has welcomed you home. Rest well, Daddy.

— Korkor



Daddy, you once told me that the very first time you saw me, you had a conviction that I would one day become your daughter-in-law. At the time, I did not fully understand what those words meant, but over the years, I witnessed how deeply you believed them.

I remember the day the Ayertey and Ayitiah families went before the Church Session to formally introduce Nii Ayi and I and to announce our intention to get married. On that day, you said something I have never forgotten: "I have not gained a daughter-in-law; I have gained a daughter." And those were words you lived by every single day. At the time, I had already lost my biological father, so hearing those words brought me a kind of comfort that is difficult to explain. They soothed a wound that was still very fresh and reassured me that I was gaining more than a husband and a new family. I was gaining a father.

We attended many functions together, and there were times when people mistook me for Shirley-Ann, your biological daughter who was then working at

Coconut Grove in Elmina. That always made me smile because it reflected how naturally I had blended into the family.

During the early years of my marriage, I spent most weekends in your home. You affectionately called me "Auntie Korkor." You would call frequently just to check on us and your grandchildren. Anytime the phone rang and I heard, "Auntie Korkor, ba wogba sane," I knew the rest of my day already belonged to you. What was meant to be a quick visit would become a whole-day affair, filled with conversations and laughter, and family.

One of the things I will never forget was how generously you cared for all of us. Every Christmas, you bought fabric for your daughters, and we would often find ourselves attending weddings dressed in the same material because you made sure each of us received fabrics for such occasions. You bought us clothes, utensils, and countless other things you believed we might need. You provided for us so well that there were times my mother would jokingly ask whether I was married to my husband or to my father-in-law.

Daddy, you were instrumental in nurturing my entrepreneurial journey. When I became your daughter, I did not know how to bake, so you gave me mummy's cake recipe book and encouraged me to practice. When I decided to commercialize the business, you supported me wholeheartedly and even purchased the machine used to cut cake boxes so that the late Mr. Mensah could produce the packaging for me. You believed in me.

But beyond the gifts and provisions, what I will cherish most is your heart. There was a time when I went through one of the most difficult periods of my life. I sat before you, struggling to hold back tears. As I shared my pain, you did not simply listen. You broke down and wept with me. You asked more “whys” than I did. You felt my pain and you carried my burden as though it were your own.

My biological father died in 2009, but God, in His mercy, gave me another father in you. And now that you are gone, Dada who will I run to? Who will call me Auntie Korkor? Who will sit with me and cry when life becomes overwhelming? Dada, why have you left me fatherless again?

Yet, who am I to question God? Today, even through my grief, I am grateful to God for the privilege of knowing you, for the fatherly love you showed me, and for the many memories I will carry for the rest of my life. Thank you for truly

treating me as your daughter. I take comfort in knowing that you are safely in the bosom of the Almighty God.

Rest well, Daddy.

— More Than a Father-In-Law

Tribute by Son-in-Law (William)

> *"The memory of the just is blessed." — Proverbs 10:7 (KJV)*

Mr. Ayitiah, I came into your life as a son-in-law, but you welcomed me as a son. For that, I will forever be grateful.

You were a remarkable man, affable, generous, honest and always supportive. Your kindness was genuine, your heart was generous, and your love for family was admirable.

One of the greatest gifts you gave me was the wonderful woman I am blessed to call my wife. Her character, strength and love for family speak volumes about the values you instilled in your children. Indeed, the beautiful family you raised remains a testimony to the kind of father you were.

During your difficult days, when my wife was helping Mummy care for you, you personally asked me to come and stay in your home. That invitation meant more than words could express. It reminded me that I was not merely an in-law, but truly a son in your eyes. Unfortunately it didn't happen.

And when the going got tough, I put aside my church activities to donate blood because mine matched yours. At the time, I thought I was simply doing what a son should do for his father. Little did I know that this would become one of my most treasured memories of you. Looking back, I realise it was a special opportunity to give a little part of myself to a man who had given so much to his family.

Mr. Ayitiah, I wish we had more time together, more moments to share and more conversations to enjoy. Though you are no longer with us, I will always cherish the beautiful memories we made and the legacy of love, honesty and generosity you left behind.

Thank you for accepting me, believing in us and treating me as your own son. Your passing has left a painful emptiness, but your goodness will continue to live through your children and everyone whose life you touched.

You may be gone from our sight, but never from our hearts.

"Nyame mfa wo nsie dwoodwoo,
Ɔmfa wo nto ne koko mu
Adɔeɛ a woayɛ ama wo abusua nti no,
Nyame mfa wo nsie dwoodwoo."

Until we meet again, Mr. Ayitiah, I will forever be grateful to you and your dear family.

Until we meet again, Mr. Ayitiah
Rest peacefully!

— Selma

To My Dearest Father In-Law(daddy)



Today, we gather to honor the life of an extraordinary man-our father, Mr. Daniel Ayitiah, Daddy. A man of vision, wisdom, deep faith and unwavering peace.

Long before you became my father in-law, you were my school, Director. In those school days at The Light Academy, you stood out not just because you loved discipline, order and excellence, but because your presence commanded respect. You taught us with your words, and sometimes just a quiet look made us want to do and be better. You always disciplined with a heart that wanted to build a child up.

When our paths crossed later in life and Nii Armah brought me into the family, you welcomed me with grace. In 2018 when my dad passed, you made arrangements for Nii Armah to attend the funeral with Bro Nii Ayi, Sister Shirley-Ann and Aunty Emelia. A gesture I can never forget mainly because I hadn't married into the family yet but you showed genuine concern and support. Thank you so much daddy.

When Nii Armah and I got married in 2021, you had a conversation with me and you said "I named him after my father. He is very dear to my heart, please take good care of him for me". Daddy, I still remember those words and with the help of God, I will do just that. You were a man full of wisdom and love. You always had a word of encouragement and always prayed for us. Your commitment to and value placed on the family was patent. You dedicated your life to building strong bonds and lifelong closeness among all of us- your

children and grandchildren. Coming home for family get togethers won't feel the same again; the rhythm of the room has changed forever because our central patriarch is no longer sitting at the table. We are encouraged by the words of the Bible in Colossians 2:5, **"For though I be absent in the flesh, yet am I with you in spirit, joying and beholding your order, and the steadfastness of your faith in Christ"**

Thank you, daddy, for being who you were to us. Thank you for being the best grandfather to Zane and Zoe. I am glad they got to spend a few months living with you before you left to be with the Lord. They will grow up to cherish those moments with you and I am certain that they will tell Baby Zuri about you. They still take turns to pray for you and they ask God to heal Grandpa and make him strong. We have explained to them that Grandpa is in heaven but I guess they will understand it better when they are older.

Daddy, your passing cut deeply and to be honest, knowing you are in a better place doesn't make it any easier, but knowing you are no longer in pain gives me some comfort. 20th September will go down as one of the most difficult days in the family, but it is well. It is privilege and an honor to have had you as a father.

Rest well at the feet of the Father you served so faithfully and so lovingly.

TRIBUTE BY GRANDCHILDREN

— Naa Ode

My years with him were very fun. He would buy me chocolates and sweets. He even bought my cousins and I cars, so we sat in them everyday when we were with him. He was very caring and respectful although he was sick he would come to the school everyday and as he was walking around my friends would always tell me to say hi. He was always strong even till death

— Dona

Though we had lots of fights he was a caring grandfather. He gave me advice for my studies.

— Korkoi

I remember when Grandpa used to buy me toys. When he ask me if I am full sometimes he even ask me if I have eaten. I miss my grandpa and I hope to see him in heaven one day.

— Armah

I remember when I was young he used to buy me so many things like cakes, chocolates and mini cars. He always asked me whether I was fine or okay. He always paid for most of the things I wanted and took me to places. I liked him so much until he fell very ill and passed away. He also told me to study and he encouraged me.

— Daniel

My grandfather was more than a grandfather. He was like a second father. He always looked out for me even in his time of sickness. He always advised me on his life experiences and pushed me on to learn. He was a kind man who brought peace and held the family together.

My grandpa is a strong God fearing man. Even when the doctors said there was nothing they could do for him again, he still stayed strong and lived for an extra month through God's kindness. But now he has been called upon. All I can say is thank you to him for bringing us here today.



TRIBUTE BY SIBLINGS

Our brother had a good heart. A truly kind heart. He did not know how to pretend. If you needed help, he was already on his way. He gave - not because he had too much but because that's who he was. Generous with his money, generous with his advice, generous with his time. He loved deeply. He loved his family, he loved his friends and he loved people even when they gave him no reason for that was his nature. He carried all of us in his heart. And above all, he loved God. His faith was not for show. He prayed for us when we needed. He tried to live what he preached - honest, humble, forgiving. Bro Kwei, you showed that being God - loving is not just about going to church. It is about how you treat people when no one is watching. Bro Kwei, our brother, you lived your purpose. God gave you to us for a time and in that time you were a good, decent and loving brother. You are faithful, helpful, generous and go out of your way to help people. If any of us needed help and support.

Personally, I Paulina have been on the receiving end of your advice, your worry about me in the UK for such a long time and wanting me to return home. Encouraging me in all my pursuits. I also remember my West Indian friend who came to Ghana for a visit as she wanted to go to Elmina Castle. Guess what, my brother arranged the trip, paid for hotel stay and food. We didn't have to pay for anything that is our brother for you. Bro Kwei, as a person you were forward thinking and in some ways rather visionary and this helped you to achieve so much. You, our dear brother, are a natural leader that guides, influences and inspires others. Some of these qualities are not always appreciated but in the long run you are proven right. As siblings we have not always seen eye to eye. We are just a normal family, not perfect and will miss you. Our brother Desmond in the UK said as you have been a mentor to him, you never stop advising him. You motivate and constantly encourage him and Zena, his wife. Desmond said they will miss your funny jokes. He remembers two songs that you love. The first one in Sunday School is that I am a soldier in the army of God. I'm gonna fight until I die. There's no turning back in the army of the Lord. Your other favorite song that he remembers is This world is not my home. I'm just passing through Jim Reeves. The angels beckon you Bro Kwei from heaven's open door and you will feel at home with the Lord. Bro Kwei, we will miss you. You touched so many lives. Today we are not just mourning your death, we are celebrating your life. Even though our hearts are broken, we take comfort that you have finished your

race and have gone to be with the Lord. 2 Timothy 4:7 says I have fought the good fight. I have finished the race, I have kept the faith. Bro Kwei, thank you. We didn't always say thanks but we say so now. Thank you for loving us and the whole family. We will take care of what you left behind. Rest in peace Dan.

— Zena

From the first day I met uncle Dan , he showed me kindness, care and compassion towards me . He is one of the most kind, caring, supportive people I know, he also has a good sense of humour. I will forever remember him and will miss him. May the Almighty God bless his soul.

Tribute From Cousins

> *1 Thessalonians 4:13–14*
> *"Brothers and sisters, we do not want you to be uninformed about those who sleep in death, so that you do not grieve like the rest of mankind, who have no hope. For we believe that Jesus died and rose again, and so we believe that God will bring with Jesus those who have fallen asleep in him." We profoundly remember Bro. Kwei for his amazing interpersonal relations, love and humility he showed us whenever he interacted with us and many other people. He welcomed and treated everyone with utmost respect and supported us greatly as much as he could. He showed keen interest in our respective developments as he inspired and encouraged us as much as possible to develop ourselves and aspire for great achievements in life. Bro. Kwei was truly a pillar of our family. Some of us as cousins got very close to him and noticed the deep affection and concern he showed in our lives as we grew up. Bro. Kwei was very sociable and willingly sacrificed his time, energy and was always ready to support family members in whatever way he could, be it financially, physically, emotionally and through his wise counsel and encouragement. He was the kind of person who would make himself available when someone needed a helping hand, a listening ear, or simply someone to lean on. His generosity went beyond material support; he gave his time, strength, love and genuine concern to the wellbeing of the family.*

Through his actions, he demonstrated what it meant to be a good brother, cousin, relative, friend and was also on hand in the planning and got deeply involved during the marriage ceremonies of some of us and other important family events. His selflessness, kindness and willingness to help others have left

a lasting impression on all of us.

Painful though the news of his death was, we console ourselves when we remember that each of us will have to return to our maker one day. We were faced with a sobering reminder of man's mortality recorded in Moses' prayer in Psalm 90:12, "Lord, teach us to number our days that we may gain a heart of wisdom."

Bro. Kwei we knew you were not well but we were not prepared for your departure and certainly did not expect to lose you so soon. We would have wished for more time with you, more conversations, more family moments and more opportunities to experience your love and support.

Although we may not understand the timing of his departure, we trust in God's perfect will and hold firmly to the hope we have in Christ. We are comforted by the assurance that those who put their faith in the Lord have the promise of eternal life. With this hope, we commit Bro. Kwei into the loving hands of his Creator, trusting that he is now at peace in the presence of the Lord.

Bro. Kwei, fare thee well and rest in perfect peace in the bosom of our Lord Jesus Christ until the day of the resurrection.

"Yaa wo Ojogbang."

TRIBUTE BY NEPHEWS AND NIECES

> *"A good man leaves an inheritance to his children's children..." — Proverbs 13:22 (KJV)*

We remember how his voice changed when he introduced someone new to the school he built. His whole manner lit up. He did not just mention it. He invited people in and asked them to get involved. For him, the school was never a monument to himself. It was an open door for others.

Most of all, we remember that he made time. He invested in each of us, one by one, and he built the bonds among all his nieces and nephews on purpose. He wanted us to know each other, to lean on each other, and to stay close. Because of him, we are not just cousins. We are family in the fullest sense.

He taught us two things above all: that family comes first, and that education opens doors. He lived both lessons, and he asked us to do the same.

Uncle Dan, we will carry your stories, your lessons, and your love. We will tell our children who you were. We will stay close, as you wanted. We will keep learning, and we will keep the door open for others, as you did.

Thank you for loving us well. Rest in peace, Uncle Dan. We love you, and we will miss you.

With love,
nieces and nephews

TRIBUTE BY THE CHURCH

Tribute in Loving Memory of the Late Mr. Daniel Kwei Ayitiah

By the Presbyterian Church of Ghana – Calvary Congregation, Haatso

> ***"I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith. Now there is in store for me the crown of righteousness, which the Lord, the righteous Judge, will award to me on that day." (2 Timothy 4:7-8)***

The Session, Pastoral Team and the entire Calvary Congregation, Haatso, with deep sorrow but with unwavering faith in the resurrection, pay this short tribute to our beloved father, teacher, counselor and a distinguished Presbyter, Mr. Daniel Kwei Ayitiah, who was called to glory on Sunday, 20th September, 2026.

The late Daniel Kwei Ayitiah joined Calvary Congregation from Osu North Congregation on 14th February, 1996. From that day, he dedicated his time, substance and talent to the growth of this church.

He was elected to serve in the second batch of Presbyters from 1997 - 2001, and served with humility, integrity and great commitment.

He was a pillar in our fundraising efforts and played major roles in the funding of church projects. For many years he was elected as the Harvest Committee Chairman, leading us to successful harvest celebrations. As a staunch member of the Tuesday Born Group, he greatly supported the group to win several awards in the annual Day-Born competitions.

During the 25th Anniversary Celebration in 2008, he was appointed a member of the Finance and Projects Sub-Committee in recognition of his loyalty and financial wisdom.

A true man of the Word, he assisted with Bible lessons and served as a Bible Class Leader from 2011-2013, feeding many souls with the Word of God. He also served on the Counseling Committee, where he played a major role in counseling many marriage couples with godly wisdom.

After a surgery overseas in 2016, he became indisposed and could not attend church regularly. By God's grace, he recuperated and for the past few years, resumed attending church services to the joy of all.

On 20th September, 2026, after a relapse, the Lord called him to rest. He has fought the good fight indeed.

1. The strife is o'er, the battle done;
Now is the Victor's triumph won;
Now be the song of praise begun;.
Alleluia!

2. The powers of death have done their Worst,
But Christ their legions hath dispersed;
Let shouts of holy joy outburst:
Alleluia! (MHB 215; 1-2)

Calvary Congregation has lost a father, a teacher, a counselor and a philanthropist, but Heaven has gained a saint. We extend our heartfelt condolences to his widow, children, grandchildren and the entire family. May the Lord comfort and keep you.

> Rest in Perfect Peace, Our Beloved Presbyter and friend.
> Adieu!! Rest well, Mr. Daniel Kwei Ayitiah – faithful servant of God.
> Yaawɔ Dzogbaŋŋ, Anyɛmi Kpakpa yɛ Nuŋtsɔ lɛ Kpɔkɔiaŋ.



Tribute by the Governing Board – the Light Academy

No words better capture the essence of our late co-founder and co-proprietor, Mr. Daniel Kwei Ayitiah, whose visionary spirit gave birth to The Light Academy. Today, we write with heavy hearts, yet with immense gratitude, to celebrate a life devoted to education and generously poured out for the benefit of the next generation.

In August 1998, Mr. Ayitiah, together with his beloved wife, Patricia, co-founded The Light Academy with a clear and inspiring vision: "To produce hardworking individuals who will be of service to mankind and, as a result, become a leading centre of learning in the country." Their mission was equally profound: "To raise children/learners of excellence who would be models to their peers."

The decision to establish the School required tremendous courage, sacrifice, determination, and unwavering faith. Where others might have seen obstacles, they saw possibilities. They firmly believed that a strong educational foundation during a child's formative years was not only essential but also a powerful equaliser in life.

To realize this vision, Mrs. Patricia Ayitiah resigned from Ridge Church School to manage the new institution full-time on basis. In 2004, Mr. Ayitiah, left his career as a Retail Manager at Barclays Bank to join her. Through years of sacrifice,

tireless effort, and an unwavering commitment to excellence, the couple nurtured their modest dream into the vibrant institution it is today.

Mr. Ayitiah became a pillar of strength, a protector, a mentor, and the heartbeat of the School. He understood that building a school was much more than constructing classrooms. It was about building character, nurturing curious and enquiring minds, developing responsible citizens, and instilling enduring values such as integrity, hard work, discipline, and resilience.

Although he has departed this earthly life, his legacy lives on - not merely in buildings and structures, but in the thousands of lives he touched and shaped. Every classroom that continues to echo with learning, every success story of our alumni, and every young person who is inspired to dream and aspire to greatness is a living testament to his vision and enduring impact.

Your health did not permit you to attend our meetings. We, however, deeply appreciate your continued interest in the affairs of the School, your trust in us, and your consistent support for the decisions we made. Your confidence in us has been a great source of encouragement and a responsibility we have never taken for granted.

Today, we assure you that your vision remains our compass. We pledge to protect and strengthen the institution you helped to build and to uphold the values upon which The Light Academy was founded. We will strive to ensure that the flame of knowledge you ignited continues to burn brightly and that generations yet unborn will benefit from the legacy you so selflessly created.

Rest in perfect peace, dear Co-founder. Your work on earth has been beautifully done. Your vision lives on, your legacy endures, and your impact will never fade.

May your gentle soul rest in perfect peace.

Tribute to the Late Mr. Daniel Kwei Ayitiah

By the Staff of the Light Academy

> *"Blessed are the dead who die in the Lord...*
> *they will rest from their labour,*
> *for their deeds will follow them." –*
> *Revelation 14:13*

With hearts deeply saddened by your passing, yet grateful to God for the gift of your impactful life, we, the staff of The Light Academy, bid a heartfelt farewell to our beloved Co-Founder and Proprietor, Mr. Daniel Kwei Ayitiah. Your life and contributions to our great institution will always be remembered with love and gratitude.

When you established The Light Academy in 1998, you did not merely build a school; you gave birth to a vision to nurture young minds, develop character, promote discipline, pursue excellence, and help children discover their God-given potential. Today, the institution stands as a living testimony to your courage, sacrifice, perseverance and unwavering belief in education.

Sir, you were a man of strong principles and unwavering integrity. You valued truthfulness, honesty, discipline, justice, hard work, and integrity. You listened before judging, considered the facts, and were not easily influenced by sentiments. You were firm, when necessary, but beneath that firmness was a heart that understood and cared for people.

You had little tolerance for dishonesty, laziness and cheating. You taught us that success without integrity is not true success and reminded us that "a good name is better than riches."

Behind your corrections was a desire to make us better; behind your difficult questions was a desire to make us think; and behind your high expectations was your belief that we could rise to them.

To the teaching and non-teaching staff, Mr. Ayitiah was a visionary leader, a rock of support and a true partner in nation-building. His open-door policy, words of encouragement during tough times and relentless drive to improve our facilities, left an indelible mark on all of us who worked alongside him. You understood that a great institution is built not only with structures and systems, but with people. You therefore invested in the growth and welfare of your staff.

You supported staff who wanted to pursue higher education and, in many instances, assisted staff whose children gained admission to university. You understood that when a teacher develops, the learner benefits, and when staff grow, the institution becomes stronger. You were not merely building a school; you were building people.

Your kindness also made many of us feel valued. You listened to staff concerns, discussed welfare and salaries, and considered people's circumstances. You had a special way of making people feel like family. Every woman or lady on

the compound was affectionately called “Akosua,” a simple name that carried warmth and affection whenever it came from you.

You were exceptionally observant. Very little escaped your attention. You asked questions not simply to obtain answers, but to make people think and take responsibility.

One unforgettable example was your habit of walking to the crèche and asking: “How many are you today?” It sounded like a simple question, but it reflected your concern for accountability and your belief that every child entrusted to us mattered.

You also had a special love for children. You frequently gave out chocolates to the preschool pupils, bringing joy to them in a way that many of us will never forget. These simple acts demonstrated the fatherly heart behind the Proprietor.

You loved asking questions. Sometimes they challenged us; sometimes they surprised us; but these always had a purpose. You were sharpening our minds, testing our understanding and preparing us for responsibility.

When The Light Academy Kitchen began operations in September 2008, you personally supervised its activities. You tasted the food before it was served, advised the patrons on nutritious meals and ensured that the necessary ingredients were available. You understood that caring for children went beyond the classroom; it included their health, nourishment and overall wellbeing.

And then there was the unforgettable “Obishi and Kwakwe.”

We remember your usual words when you jokingly described yourself as the “Rat,” meaning “Obishi” in Ga, while referring to the staff or any other person as the “Mouse,” meaning “Kwakwe.” You particularly used these expressions when speaking about trust, human behaviour and the things people sometimes tried to keep from you.

Sir, you never used these words to offend or belittle anyone. You said them jovially, often with a smile, to ease tension and bring humour into the moment. But beneath the humour was a deeper message about your remarkable smartness, sharpness and ability to read situations and people.

In your own humorous way, you were telling us that before you thought someone had figured something out, you had probably thought about it already. You often seemed to be several steps ahead. You could observe a situation, understand what was happening and sometimes know where a conversation was heading before the person had finished explaining.

It was also your way of reminding us that you could easily recognize when someone was not being truthful, even when the lie was being told directly to your face. Your sharp mind, alertness and extraordinary observation made it difficult to conceal things from you.

That is why the words "Obishi and Kwakwe" became more than just a joke. They became a memorable reflection of your intelligence, wisdom, quick thinking, awareness and remarkable ability to anticipate things.

Many of us will forever remember moments when we thought we were being smart, the Obishi had already seen it coming.

Sir, you have left us much more than buildings, classrooms and facilities. You have left us a living legacy, a culture of unity, discipline, hard work, truthfulness, empathy, responsibility and excellence.

You planted seeds in the lives of countless people. Some of those seeds became teachers, professionals, leaders and responsible citizens. Perhaps one of the most touching testimonies is the doctor who cared for you during your illness was once a child you helped nurture and educate. Indeed, the good we do in the lives of others may return to us in ways we never expect.

Even when your health did not allow you to be as active as before, you still made time to walk around the school and interact with many of us daily. Those simple moments meant a lot to us. Your presence brought warmth and joy to the school, and your friendly nature made us feel your care and concern. We will always remember these walks, your smiles, your questions, and the way you warmly interacted with us. Your presence may be missed, but the warmth you shared with us will remain in our hearts.

In this time of mourning, let us transcend the physical realm and seek comfort in the assurance that our cherished father, grandfather and co-Proprietor has found eternal peace with his Maker. we hold firmly to our faith in the Lord and the words in the Presbyterian Hymn- ***526.***

"For all the saints who from their labour's rest,
Who Thee by faith before the world confessed,
Thy Name, O Jesus, be forever blessed,
Alleluia!"

Today, we believe that you have completed your earthly assignment, fought the good fight, finished the race and kept the faith.

Sir, there are still questions we wish we could ask you and moments we wish we could share with you. But rather than hold only to our tears, we choose to hold on to your lessons.

You will live on in every classroom where a teacher inspires a child, in every lesson taught, every equation solved, every graduation celebrated, every staff member you supported, every "Akosua" called with affection, every chocolate shared with a child, every question that makes us think, and every life lifted because you cared.

The Light Academy is your legacy.
The people you touched are your legacy.
The children you helped shape are your legacy.
And the values you instilled in us will continue to speak for you.

Mr. Daniel Kwei Ayitiah, you were our Founder, Proprietor, Leader, Teacher, Mentor and, to many of us, a father.

Today, we bid you farewell with tears in our eyes, gratitude in our hearts and faith in our souls.

Ayekoo for the vision.
Ayekoo for the sacrifices.
Ayekoo for the discipline.
Ayekoo for the kindness.
Ayekoo for the wisdom.
Ayekoo for the people you built.
Ayekoo for The Light Academy.

Your earthly labour is over, but your work continues through us. Your voice may be silent, but your lessons still speak.

Rest well, our dear Founder and Proprietor.
Rest well, our beloved Obishi.
The Kwakwe will continue the journey.

THE LIGHT YOU KINDLED WILL CONTINUE TO SHINE.
REST IN PERFECT PEACE, MR. DANIEL KWEI AYITIAH.
UNTIL WE MEET AGAIN IN THE PRESENCE OF OUR MAKER.

TRIBUTE BY ABSA BANK (FORMERLY BARCLAYS BANK)

Tribute by BBG - ABSA Retired Staff Association to the Memory of the Late Daniel Kwei Ayitiah

> ***"Precious in the sight of the LORD is the death of His godly ones." (Psalm 116:15)***

It is with profound sadness and a deep sense of loss that the Retired Staff of Barclays Bank Ghana / Absa Bank Ghana Ltd. pay tribute to our departed colleague, Mr. Daniel Kwei Ayitiah.

Mr. Ayitiah, as he was affectionately called by colleagues and customers, but simply "Kwei" to close friends, joined Barclays Bank (now Absa Bank) on 22nd November, 1971. He began his banking career at Tema Main Branch, where he worked for five years. He was taken through the rudiments of the profession at the branch and at the Bank's Training School in Accra, and was confirmed as a permanent staff after his six-month probationary period.

He was a very hardworking gentleman — punctual, respectful, and always ready to lend a helping hand where needed.

In 1977, he was transferred to Knutsford Avenue Branch, Accra. On 21st August, 1978, he was promoted to 'B' Signatory status and transferred to Tamale Branch. Through diligence and dedication, he earned promotion to 'A' Signatory status in 1981 and was transferred to High Street Branch, Accra, where he served as Head of Treasury, overseeing the Branch Tellers.

In 1984, he was nominated to attend an Instructors' Course at the University of Cape Coast to become an Instructor at the Bank's Training School, and was later trained in the United Kingdom as an Instructor. In 1991, he was promoted to 'A' Appointed status and transferred to the High Street Foreign Exchange Department as Bills and Credit Manager.

In 1992, when the timber export business became highly competitive in the Ashanti Region, he was transferred to Kumasi, Prempeh II Street Branch, to manage the export business. In 1994, he was promoted to Retail Manager and transferred to Cape Coast Branch. In 1996, he was transferred to Tema Main Branch as the Substantive Manager and finally retired at Circle branch on 31st January, 2004 after joining just the previous year.

The late Daniel Ayitiah joined the BBG - ABSA Retired Staff Association on 22nd February, 2006. He was very regular at meetings until his health began to

fail him.

Ataa Kwei — "Dza ŋkɛɛ mifoo odaŋ" — to wit, "Unless I say I won't mind you."

As we mourn his passing, we extend our heartfelt condolences to his family, friends and loved ones. We pray that God grants them strength, comfort and peace during this difficult time.

Rest in perfect peace.

Yaawɔ jogbaŋŋ, Anyɛmi kpakpa.

TRIBUTE BY OSU SALEM

IN LOVING MEMORY OF LATE DANIEL KWEI AYITIAH BY HIS CHILDHOOD CLASSMATES OSU PRESBYTERIAN UPPER, LOWER PRIMARY AND OSU PRESBYTERIAN MIDDLE BOYS BOARDING SCHOOL –SALEM 1956-1964.

SEVENTY YEARS AGO IN JUNE 1956, A GROUP OF STRANGE "NINOS" CONSISTING OF TWENTY (25) CHILDREN (BOYS) FROM ACROSS OSU AND ACCRA CONVERGED WITH THEIR PARENTS ON THE PRESBYTERIAN LOWER PRIMARY SCHOOL (KPENPLE TOI) ST. THOMAS, TO BE ADMITTED TO START THEIR EDUCATION.

A SMALLISH, SMART PLUMP AND UNASSUMING BOY DANIEL KWEI AYITIAH ARRIVED WITH HIS PARENTS TO JOIN THE FOLD TO BE ADMITTED INTO CLASS ONE(1).

DANIEL AS WE AFFECTIONATELY CALLED HIM WAS VERY RESERVED AS ALL THE OTHER CHILDREN UNTIL WE ALL REACHED CLASS THREE LOWER PRIMARY.

BETWEEN 1959-1962 WE WERE ALL TRANSFERRED TO THE PRESBYTERIAN BOYS UPPER PRIMARY SCHOOL WHICH WAS SITUATED UNDER THE THEN PRESBYTERIAN DAY SECONDARY SCHOOL BUILDING (SENDO)

IN JUNE OF 1962, DANIEL AND HIS CLASS MATES HAD TO SIT AN EXAMINATION TO BE ADMITTED TO THE PRESBYTERIAN MIDDLE BOYS BOARDING SCHOOL OSU SALEM, TO CONTINUE WITH THEIR MIDDLE SCHOOL EDUCATION. SALEM WAS A STRICT TO A FAULT PRESBYTERIAN SCHOOL WHERE PRESBYTERIAN DISCIPLINE WAS HIGHLY ENFORCED. THE HEADMASTER WAS MASTER E. BARNOR. SOME OF ITS PAST TUTORS WERE MR. AKWASI, E.N.TETTEH, MR. AGYEI AND OTHERS. FOR TWO YEARS SALEM BECAME OUR MOTHER AND HOME. DANIEL WAS PARTICULARLY VERY SOCIABLE AND A

MIXER. HE ALWAYS CARRIED A SMILE ON HIS FACE, AND THE YOUNG LAD WAS ADMIRED AND REMEMBERED BY HIS NEATNESS AND PUNCTUALITY. HE WAS VERY HUMBLE AND NEVER WAS HE PUNISHED FOR BEING UNTIDY. HIS ADVANTAGE AND WE ALSO FOUND OUT THAT HE WAS AN INDIGENE OF THE POPULAR C.D.C HOUSE AT OSU

WHICH HAD CLOSE PROXIMITY TO OSU SALEM. WE WOULD SNEAK AND FOLLOW DANIEL TO EAT HOT KENKEY AT HOME- BUT LO' AND BEHOLD' YOU WOULDN'T DARE TO BE CAUGHT BY A SENIOR... YOU WOULD BE DEAD MEAT.

OUR DEAR LATE BROTHER WAS ACADEMICALLY EXCELLENT. WE HAD TO LEARN AND LIVE IN THE PRESBYTERIAN BOYS BOARDING SCHOOL ENVIRONMENT FOR TWO YEARS UNDER STRICT SUPERVISION. WE HAD TO LEARN MUSIC, PLAY THE PIANO, PLAY FOOTBALL, LEARN HOW TO SCRUB, SWEEP, SERVE IN THE DINING HALL, GO TO ASSEMBLY AND CHURCH ON TIME AND KEPT A PLOT THAT YOU SWEPT AND WORKED- ON EVERY DAY BEFORE YOU WENT TO CLASS. THE SCHOOL UNIFORM WAS WHITE SHIRT WITH KHAKI SHORTS WITH A BAND OR BELT STRAPPED IN YOUR MID SECTION. YOUR CHURCH CLOTHES WERE SPOTLESS WHITE SHIRT AND TROUSERS WITH A BLUE BLACK BLASER. SMARTNESS AND CLEANLINESS WAS THE ORDER OF THE DAY. YOU HAD TO KEEP CLEAN ALL THE TIME. SALEM WAS A HAPPY HOME FOR ALL OF US AND A REAL EXPERIENCE THAT PREPARED US MENTALLY AND PHYSICALLY FOR SECONDARY SCHOOL.

IN 1964, AFTER TWO YEARS OF COMPETITIVE STUDY AT OSU SALEM, DANIEL KWEI AYITIAH AND HIS CLASSMATES HAD TO TAKE THE COMMON ENTRANCE EXAMINATION THAT WOULD TRANSITION THEM TO SECONDARY SCHOOL. HE PASSED THE COMMON ENTRANCE EXAMINATION AND WAS ADMITTED TO LA BONE SECONDARY SCHOOL TO CONTINUE HIS SECONDARY SCHOOL EDUCATION THAT WOULD PROPREL HIM FOR HIGHER EDUCATION.

BUT THIS IS WHERE WE WILL SEPARATE FROM EACH OTHER. MANY OF THE OTHER CLASSMATES THAT LEFT SALEM IN 1964 HAD ADMISSIONS INTO OTHER SCHOOLS OF HIGHER LEARNING.

AFTER SEVERAL YEARS OF SEPARATION A FEW OF HIS CLASSMATES DECIDED TO LINK TOGETHER. BUT THIS IS SIXTYTWO (62) YEARS OF SEPARATION AND WAS QUITE DIFFICULT TO LINK OURSELVES EXCEPT BY TELEPHONE. WE CONTACTED DANIEL BUT IT WAS A BIT TOO LATE TO CRACK JOKES AND REMEMBER THE GOOD OLD DAYS. HE HAD TAKEN ILL.

DANIEL'S SHOCKINGPASSING WAS SPLASHED ON MY WHATSAPP CHAT PAGE BY HIS SON JOSEPH AYITIAH WHEN I WAS ALSO INVITING HIM TO THE OBSEQUIES OF ANOTHER CLASSMATES.

ON THAT NOTE: WE SAY REST IN PEACE DEAR BROTHER, REST IN PERFECT PEACE IN THE BOSOM OF OUR LORD,

YAA WO DZOGBANN ANYEMI!!!

AMEN!!

A TRIBUTE TO THE MEMORY OF THE LATE MR DANIEL KWEI AYITIAH, "THE PRESBYTERIAN BANKER"

BY PROFESSOR H. NII-ADZIRI WELLINGTON, FGA/OV

> *" The LORD is my Shepherd; I have all that I need. He lets me rest in green meadows.... Surely your goodness and unfailing love will pursue me all the days of my life, and I will live in the House of the LORD forever." (Psalm 23, verses 1-6). [Life Application Study Bible - NLT].*

Ataa Kwei, as I used to address him, has been known to me and my wife, Jessie Shormeh Wellington (Nee Odamtten), since our Osu Fellowship (SU) days at the La Bone Secondary School.

When I completed my university education at the KNUST, Kumasi in 1969, before leaving for Germany for further studies, the late James Nii-Noi Quist-Therson, who was with me at the KNUST, felt the need to establish a Scripture Union Fellowship at Osu.

We sought and received permission from our SU Leaders in Accra to establish a Fellowship, which we dubbed "Osu Fellowship," located at the La Bone Secondary School.

The Fellowship thrived very well and it grew by leaps and bounds.

My girl friend, the then Miss Jessie Shormeh Odamtten, came to join the Fellowship, being an old SU person.

When I had left for Germany for further studies, Brother Daniel Kwei Ayitiah also came to join the Fellowship and thus Shormeh became acquainted with Ataa Kwei.

Upon completion with my studies in 1972, I was appointed as a Lecturer at the KNUST, my Alma Mater. I began my academic career with my recently wedded wife, Mrs Jessie Wellington.

While in Kumasi, we knew a Campus lady, Mrs Anne Gidigasu. She was the person who named Ataa Kwei " Presbyterian Banker" because Ataa Kwei impressed her as a Barclays Bank customer with his spirituality, whenever she went to town at Adum in Kumasi to do business at the Bank.

Later she got to know the denomination of Ataa Kwei -as a Presbyterian. When I told her that I knew Ataa Kwei from Osu. And whenever Ataa Kwei's name popped up in our conversation, she referred to him as the " Presbyterian Banker".

When I asked her for an explanation, she told me that with the interaction she had with Ataa Kwei, as the Branch Manager of the Barclays Bank on Harper Road, he came across as a disciplined, intelligent and respectful person, which are traits of Presbyterian gentlemen.

And then, when we eventually relocated upon retirement from the KNUST to live at Haatso, we met Ataa Kwei with her Spirit-filled, friendly and admirable wife, Auntie Patricia.

We became quite close as a family. Ataa Kwei and Sister Pat showed us so much kindness and love - they presented us regularly with generous gifts each Christmas.

When the Bible Study Programme in the Calvary Congregation began, the preparatory class of the Teachers, were started in our home at 6 Ataa Sowah Drive in the North/ East Haatso community.

We gathered Friday evenings to go through the Study Materials and to pray, in preparation for teaching the Classes the next Sunday.

For these times of preparations came to our home, Ataa Kwei who was chauffeured by his last born, Nii Armah; then Dr Kwame Appianing-Addo now Prof Kwame Appianing-Addo; the young Michael Sowa-Nortey, now a Reverend Minister of the Presbyterian Church of Ghana and the Registrar, Akrofi-Christaller Institute (ACI), a post-graduate Institution of High Learning.

The people mentioned above, constituted the crop of Teachers for the Bible Study Classes in the Calvary Congregation of the PCG at Haatso.

Today we bid farewell to one of us as the original crop of teachers.

As we thank the Lord for the life and work of Mr Daniel Kwei Ayitiah in the Calvary Congregation, we praise God, for granting our beloved brother the grace to experience in reality the truth of the above quoted Scripture -Psalm 23. Verses 1-6.

Ataa Kwei, rest in peace in your Saviour and Lord, yaawo odjogbann yer o Nuntso ler mli. Amen!!!

Tribute by Rev Alfred Nortey

> *" I have found a friend, Oh such a friend!*
> *He loved me ere I knew Him;*
> *He drew me with the cords of love,*
> *And thus He bound me to Him.*
> *And round my heart still closely twine*
> *Those ties which naught can sever,*
> *For I am His and He is mine,*
> *Forever and forever"*
> By Charles William

Mr. Daniel Ayitiah was one of the students I taught Mathematics at the La Bone Senior High School from 1968 to 1971. He and his colleagues were also members of the Scripture Union.

When he was getting ready for marriage, I had to encourage him to overcome unnecessary family obstacles. Soon after marriage I invited him and his wife Mama Pat, to join the Couple Fellowship which I established for the Christians living at Osu and beyond. One major event of the Fellowship was a retreat to the Aburi Gardens where we spent the weekend. Some of the lessons covered became a solid foundation for him and his friends for a successful marriage.

Many years later when the Light Academy school was established by him and the wife, he invited me to serve as a chairman of the Board of Director of the school. This privilege enabled us to share ideas and support each other until his retirement.

My family will forever remember and be grateful to Mr. Daniel Ayitiah for his support which enabled us to transfer money to the United States of America. This was over a decade ago when our family members in the USA died. Since it was not possible to bring down the corpse neither was the family able to send a delegation aboard it was decided to send a donation to support the wife and children.

For such a transaction we needed someone who has a foreign bank account. It was at such a critical moment that I had to approach Mr. Daniel Ayitiah to help us. He wrote on a piece of paper to see on see one of the branches Manages at Barclays Bank now known as ABASA. As soon as got there the transfer was done; and in less than 24 hours the wife received the money in dollars. Truly, Proverbs 18:24 says there is a friend who sticks closer than a brother.

On festive occasions brother Dan will visit with his dear wife mama Pat, with huge parcels. When he became very busy Mr Ayitiah will call on the phone and tell me to go and see Tailor Quarshie to take your measurements. When the suit was completed for collection, I would ask Mr. Quarshie how much it would have cost me, the reply was that "this is a business deal between me and Dan". Oh, what a friend! Dan, your generosity will forever be remembered.

May the good Lord keep you in perfect REST until we meet again.

A Tribute to a Dear Friend and Brother

By T. C. Fleischer



It is with profound grief, but also with deep gratitude, that I pay tribute to a very dear friend who, over the years, became much more than a friend. He became a brother and a trusted friend of my family.

Our story with Uncle Dan goes back to the late 1970s, when we met him and his contemporaries as our older brothers and sisters at the Osu Christian Fellowship at Labone SDA Church. Little did we know then that one of those young men we looked up to would become such an important and enduring part of our lives.

Our relationship grew much closer in 1987, when I had the privilege of serving as Best Man at a wedding where his car was used. In his usual generous and selfless manner, Uncle Dan decided to chauffeur us himself. Looking back, that simple gesture reflected the kind of person he was. He gave not only what he had, but also his time, energy, presence and heart.

As the years passed, our friendship deepened. When his work brought him to Kumasi, our families became even closer. He became a dependable and trusted family friend – someone whose presence was reassuring because you knew you could count on him.

During some of the most difficult seasons of my life, when I felt buffeted by uncertainty, disappointment and pain, Uncle Dan stood by me. He encouraged me, listened to me and helped me regain my footing when life seemed unsteady.

He was exceptionally kind, generous and compassionate. He genuinely cared about people, and when he chose to help, he did so wholeheartedly. Many people here today could tell their own stories of how he helped, encouraged or supported them.

He was down-to-earth, approachable and genuine, with a wonderful sense of humour. He could make you laugh when you least expected it, and those moments of laughter are among the memories I will always treasure.

Uncle Dan has left deep and indelible footprints in my life. His friendship enriched me, his kindness touched my family, his counsel guided me, his generosity encouraged me, and his presence during difficult times gave me strength. For all of this, I am deeply grateful.

Today, therefore, I choose to remember him not only with tears, but with gratitude—for the years of friendship, laughter, conversations, counsel and companionship, and for the privilege of calling him my friend, my brother and my confidant.

Uncle Dan, you have run your race. You touched many lives and left footprints that will remain long after we have said our final goodbyes. With a broken heart but a grateful spirit, I say, "Thank you, my dear friend and brother."

A part of you will always remain with those whose lives you touched, and you will always remain a part of our story.

Rest peacefully, my dear friend and brother.

You are deeply missed, always remembered, and never forgotten.

Tribute to Kwei Ayitiah from Solo



> *"A man who has friends must himself be friendly, But there is a friend who sticks closer than a brother".*

Daniel Kwei AYITIAH is the embodiment of Proverbs 18:24. He demonstrated and allowed me to experience the reality of this Bible verse in my life in a number of ways; in good times and difficult times.

I first knew Kwei AYITIAH in Christian circles but we developed closer friendship when I joined him, Emelia Nortey (Hesse) and the late James Quist-Therson (Uncle James) in 1976 at Osu Children's home near Labone Secondary School, for weekly Sunday School. Our friendship flourished and developed into a family relationship.

Bro Kwei was deeply loyal to his family and friends. He consistently offered myself and my family a true, devoted, steadfast, and sacrificial love during all the years I have known him.

Dan had an insatiable curiosity to improve his knowledge and understanding of his Christian faith and doctrine, that made him participate in a number of Navigators Bible studies, seminars and training. This curiosity was also evidence in his reading and asking penetrating questions.Furthermore this insatiable curiosity manifested in encouraging others to improve their educational and transferable skills for the labour market.

Mr AYITIAH was also generous and kind with his time and money. He and his family operated an 'open home' where everyone is welcome. His capacity to be generous reflected in paying school fees for a number of people who are not related to him. Uncle Dan and his family housed and provided for us many times on our holidays in Ghana. We also welcome them few times when they visited the UK on holidays.

Bro Kwei always wanted the best for myself and my family and I am sure that is the same for everyone he encountered. In this context 3 John 1:2 summarises Bro Kwei's attitude and desire for people he encountered. "Dear friend, I pray that you may enjoy good health and that all may go well with you, even as your soul is getting along well"

Mr AYITIAH never left anybody poorer' , He always left them 'richer'.

Daniel Kwei AYITIAH has served his generation well with hard work, honesty, kindness, and integrity. And today God has called him home and as the sayings go

"He's gone to a better place" and "Heaven's gain is our loss". This is a cliche but true (Psalm 116:15

Kwei AYITIAH was a friend and brother indeed! I have lost a good brother, my best friend and my confidant.

Bro Kwei Rest in the blossom of the Father, to rise again in Glory!!!!!

We thank God for giving us Daniel Kwei AYITIAH.

Thank you Sis Pat, your children and grandchildren for sharing your husband, father and grandfather with us

STO.

Tribute to the Cherished Memory of Mr Daniel Kwei Ayitiah

BY THE JOHNSON FAMILY

> *Now praise we great and famous men, the fathers named in story;*
> *And praise the Lord who now as then, reveals in man His glory.*
> *Praise we the peaceful men of skill, who builded homes of beauty;*
> *And rich in art made richer still, the brotherhood of duty.*

Nii Odeneho Kwei the Kl1` kl1` !

Where do we begin this eulogy? My husband and I have been very close to Mr Daniel Kwei Ayitiah and his family for well over 40 years! This was when Johnnie and I, Naomi, together with Dan, and his beautiful wife, Sister Pat, were members of the Osu Christian Fellowship, a Christian group which operated like the Scripture Union, but worked among adults in the communities in Accra. This was in the late seventies and early eighties. In the late nineties, our family joined Dan's at the Calvary Congregation of the Presbyterian Church of Ghana. This strengthened our relationship, especially when we realised that Johnnie had blood relationship with Dan.

Our relationship was beyond that of Christianity. Dan was like a big brother to us. He counseled us, mentored us and opened his life to us. He was always present at events of our family, offering as much help as he could. We recall a very significant role he played during our wedding in 1983, and also, during those of our children in later years. The excitement and enthusiasm Dan and his family showed during these times were beyond description! Dan, today, in public, Johnnie, Ekow, Adoma and I, together with our grandchildren, say "Thank you so very much, and God bless the family you are leaving behind." We know you to be a very good person, a very bold person who faced issues head-on and, who did not beat about the bush when he had an opinion on an issue. This will remain with us for the rest of our lives.

He loved his family, too, very deeply and one could see that he always ensured that his dear wife, Sister Pat was well protected and cared for always

What made Dan live the kind of impactful life he lived? To us, it was because he was a practical person. He therefore practiced the Christian principles he learnt, showing love, care and support, and offering help wherever and whenever he felt it was needed. He loved to see all those around him comfortable and happy. .

Dan loved the Lord Jesus Christ deeply and this showed in the ways he handled things concerning God. His love for God reflected in all he did for others. He loved Studying the Bible and readily availed himself in leading Bible Study in the church and in his house. It was very interesting looking at the way he involved his whole body, with some awkward facial expressions, in his explanation of Biblical principles.

When we saw Dan battling his illness, we were broken, and we prayed for the Lord to heal him completely. At several points, we saw the Lord's intervention in wonderful ways. However, at the right time the Lord took his hand, and led him home. Dan, you are now at rest, and we thank the merciful Lord for gifting you to the world. Brother Dan, we already miss you terribly and we pray the Lord to comfort your loved ones and your family with His peace, which is beyond human understanding. We pray He keeps you safe till we meet again, on the Resurrection Day, to part no more.

Fare well, our big brother Dan. Rest in peace, our friend and Uncle; Nii Odeneho, sleep well in the Lord. Amen

Tribute by Gilbert Ayisi Addo

I have known Mr. Daniel K.Ayitiah for the past forty six (46) years. I was then only ten (10) years old. He was my Sunday school teacher at the Osu Children's Home at Labone. He took a liking for me after I won a Bible memory verses competition which he organized for the kids. His affection, generosity and love radiated so much towards us. In fact, one day, I asked him, "Are you Jesus?" He smiled and said "No, Gilbert. I am only trying to follow the teachings of Jesus Christ."

Throughout my secondary school days, he continued to take a very keen interest in my educational and spiritual development. My parents retired and went to settle in the village. I lost contact with him as he relocated from Labone to his current residence at Adenta. You can imagine his delight when I located him during my university days. Apparently, Mr. Dan Ayitiah had sent his junior brother to the campus of the University of Ghana, Legon to search for me, hall by hall, but without success. You can trust Mr. Daniel K. Ayitiah to do that.

His generosity was unparallel. He was always ready to assist the needy. After completing my Bachelor of Laws (L.LB) program in 1994, my education was about to be truncated. I had no money to pay the school fees. He promptly stepped in and paid my fees for the two-year professional course at the Ghana School of Law. He paid for my call to the bar 30 years ago and bought my wig and gown. Anytime I met him, I had to quickly take a second look at my Christian life. Till his death, he was full of compassion, love and wise counsel for all who crossed his path. His faith in God was unshaken. On my last visit to him, we chatted for some time. I asked for permission to leave with the excuse that my driver had not eaten since morning, to enable him buy some food to eat. He quickly replied that "No, don't go. My wife can organize some food for him." We pleaded and left. My driver, in shock remarked that, "What a man! Even with his condition, he is still thinking of others?" Yes, that is the man, Mr. Daniel K. Ayitiah for you.

You will forever be missed. Rest in peace, Dad! God be with you till we meet again.

Tribute by H.E. Edwin Nii Adjei

> *"A man that hath friends must show himself friendly; and there is a friend that sticketh closer than a brother" (Proverbs 18:24)*

Daniel and I had a very close and wonderful friendship that lasted over several years. Our friendship started somewhere in 1974, when three of us, Dan, Samson and I used to attend weekly Sunday meetings together at Osu Christian Fellowship at Labone. We also worshipped at Osu Ebenezer Presbyterian Church and would often meet to chat after church services, before parting ways. When

later Samson left us for further studies at Howard University in Washington DC, USA, the two of us continued our friendship. Dan was then already working at Barclays Bank (now Absa Bank), while I was still a student in university.
But over the years, we continued to relate even when he was transferred from Accra to Tamale. Dan had many other friends and colleagues, both from school and the bank where he worked, who were dear to him. It was however a pleasant surprise to me when he asked me to be his best man for his wedding, when he got married to his sweetheart Mrs Patricia Ayitiah in 1979 at the Ridge Church in Accra. It was a very joyous occasion and I was honoured to be part of that glorious celebration on that beautiful Saturday. Over the years, we continued to keep in touch no matter where we were, in or outside Accra. I got to know his family very well, as he also got to know mine. He made me feel like a brother, not just an acquaintance. Dan was warm as a person and it was always a joy to be around him.

He extended his friendship with me to my dear wife, when Matilda and I got married, Dan went out of his way to invite us to stay at his home in Adentan, because I was due to travel soon after to Namibia on posting. He also went further to invite us again to come over to Kumasi where he had then been transferred, to spend a few days with him. This tribute is therefore also from the two of us, to show our appreciation to our dear friend Dan. He was now our friend, not mine alone. Our two families including our wives and children continued to get closer and became more than friends. We became family.

Over the decades, as Kwei's career with Barclays Bank (now Absa Bank) had taken him to various parts of Ghana and we had also had to travel abroad due to work, we had stayed in touch. Whenever we returned to Ghana, we continued to visit each other's homes. It was such a delight to welcome him and his son Kenneth to visit us in Prague in 2003. It is therefore very difficult for us to say goodbye to such a close confidant and brother.

Dan was also very steadfast in his Christian faith and beliefs as a truly born-again believer and follower of the Lord Jesus Christ. For many years, I watched him with admiration as he taught Child Evangelism classes of young people at the premises of the Osu Children's Home at Labone. Dan fulfilled this ministry with utmost devotion. He was actively involved in the membership of the Child Evangelism Fellowship of Ghana, as well as a devoted member of The Navigators, with a keen interest in Christian discipleship and consciously

helping many young men to grow stronger in their walk with God, while nurturing them in how to balance their careers and their christian faith.

He was a true confidant and one could be sure that no matter what you shared with him, you could trust Kwei to keep it between the two of you. Dan also had a memorable sense of humour. He could laugh at himself and at others, without giving offence. He could therefore make you laugh at yourself as well. He could make something that seemed sad to look comical, as he teased. We therefore laughed together through difficult as well as good times.

Kwei could tell you the hard truth. When it was good, he would tell you so. And when you had not done well or handled something the way you should have, he would also tell you.

Kwei, in my estimation, was innocent as a dove, but wise as a serpent as Jesus exhorts us in the Scriptures (Matthew 10:16). Therefore, though he was in the world, he was not of the world. He understood the word system excellently. Therefore Kwei would sometimes advise or solve problems in such a way that you would ask yourself: ''How did Dan know this?'' or ''How did he get this idea?'' He knew the world so well!

Today, as I pay tribute to Dan, I honour a legacy that reminds us that some lives are measured not by how long they are lived, but by the impact they leave behind. Dan may no longer be with us today, but the fire lit by the warm friendship we shared, lives on in our hearts. Matilda and I will continue to hold onto and cherish the memories of the times we had together with you and Patricia. Dan, you live on in our hearts. Therefore Matilda and I and the three young men will continue to think of you everyday and hold you dear in our bosoms. To live in the hearts of those you love, is not to die. Your earthly sojourn may be over, but you are not forgotten. May Kwei's memory continue to inspire all those whose lives he touched as he did ours.

''Now the Labourer's task is over,
Now the battle day is past,
Now upon the farthest shore
Lands the voyager at last.
Father, in thy gracious keeping
Leave we now thy servant sleeping.''

We will miss you dearly, Dan. Rest in peace, Servant of God and rise in glory.

Kwei, wɔnaanyo kpakpa waa lɛ, jɔɔ ohe yɛ toiŋjɔlɛ ni yeɔ emuu mli, kɛyashi wɔbaakpe ekoŋŋ!

A Tribute from George Alfred Mensah

(a son in every way that mattered)

> *"Do not let your hearts be troubled. You believe in God; believe also in me. My Father's house has many rooms... I am going there to prepare a place for you." — John 14:1–3*

Today, I find myself in a moment I never wanted to face. I don't know where to start. I always thought I'd have more time, that one day I'd return home as the man you raised me to be, and you'd see it for yourself. All I can remember now is your favorite phrase from our Bible studies: "...abundantly abundant."

I arrived at your doorstep crying, with no idea how much you would come to mean to me. You took me in, a boy you'd barely met, sent to you because of a kindness between you and a man who wasn't even your own blood. You didn't have to take me in. You chose to, every single day, for over a decade.

I remember rushing to your office because my eyes were burning, and you didn't hesitate. You drove me straight to the clinic, and that's how we found out I needed glasses. I remember waking up sick at midnight and knocking on your door, and you rushed me to the hospital and sat with me until morning. I was a stubborn boy, Daddy. You never ran out of patience for me, and somehow, you always had a way of turning my foolishness into a lesson instead of a punishment. When you demanded excellent grades from me, I used to think you were being unnecessarily harsh. Now I understand it's what pushed me to strive for excellence, in everything I do, even now.

You never missed Joy FM at dawn, and your Saturday cooking was an event none of us forgot, we fought over the leftovers for days after. Watching you and Mummy together taught me what a marriage was supposed to look like and I always hoped that one day I'd bring the person I love to you both, so you could tell us how it's done. Every achievement I had, I wanted to hear you say you were proud of me. That's how much your voice meant to me. I graduated, and you told me how impressed you were, and I decided to wait to call you again until I had a

job to tell you about. I have that job now, Daddy, and you were the first person I wanted to call.

Daddy, you were a man of such quiet generosity. You opened your home to kids from everywhere. You never spoke of it as sacrifice, you just lived it, year after year, without needing anyone to notice. You carried yourself with the same care in everything you touched, whether it was the school you built, the staff who respected you, or the quiet way you looked out for every child who came through your doors. You were principled without being rigid, strict without being unkind. People who met you once remembered you. People who lived under your roof, like I did, never forgot you.

I never got the chance to call you to tell you about my job. But you already gave me what I would have called to say thank you for. You gave me hope, the kind that doesn't leave even now. That is what I will carry forward, in your name.

Rest well, Daddy. Till we meet again.

Tribute to Mr. Daniel Kwei Ayitiah- By Felix Crabbe Ababio (Paa- Tee)

Mr Daniel Kwei Ayitiah, as we all know him formally or affectionately, **Bro Kwei**, is a man I could use so many words to describe, yet I still do not believe those words would fully capture what he meant to me.

He was my uncle, but in many ways, he cared for me as though I were his own son.

One of the most important chapters of my life was shaped directly by his kindness and generosity. When my grandmother would not allow me to attend Prempeh College, it was Bro Kwei who stepped in and helped secure my admission to Winneba Secondary School. He did not stop there. He paid my school fees throughout my years in school and made sure that I had the opportunity to continue my education.

That support was not something small. It helped build the foundation upon which much of my life today stands.

I also remember his regular visits whenever he was travelling towards Cape Coast. Even though, as the years passed, I did not have as much interaction with

him as I would have wished, I have never forgotten, and I will never forget, the help, care and support he gave me during those important formative years.

My memories of staying with him go far beyond school and financial support. Those days also played an important part in shaping my spiritual life and discipline.

I remember learning Bible recitals and being encouraged to spend quiet time in prayer and reflection. I remember our morning devotions and attending Sunday church services together. Even something as simple as being given fresh currency notes for our Sunday offering remains vivid in my memory. At the time, these may have seemed like small things, but today I understand how much they helped teach me reverence, discipline, gratitude and respect for God.

And I still remember the very first Psalm I learnt during those days, **Psalm 1**.

"Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly…"

Those words stayed with me. Looking back now, it means a great deal to me that one of my earliest memories of learning Scripture is connected to the time I spent with Bro Kwei. It reminds me that his influence on my life was not only educational or financial, but also spiritual.

I remember the days I stayed with him, the vacations and the short weekends I spent with him and his family. I remember simple but special moments in his home. I remember him cooking, and I especially remember the unique bread he used to bake in that beautiful basket style. These may appear to be ordinary memories, but to me they have remained precious pieces of my childhood and of the man I knew as Bro Kwei.

For many years, I longed and wished for another opportunity to sit with him, spend time with him and perhaps tell him personally how much I appreciated everything he did for me. But life has its own way of changing things. Circumstances change. Relationships sometimes become distant, and new chapters and relationships are formed.

Yet time and distance can never erase genuine kindness.

The people who helped us when we were still building the foundations of our lives occupy a special place in our story. Their sacrifices may have happened many years ago, but the impact remains with us.

That is what Bro Kwei represents in my life.

It saddens my heart deeply that I am writing these words at a time when he is no longer here to read them. I wish I had the opportunity to tell him directly how

grateful I am, especially for what he did for me during my years at Winneba Secondary School and for the values he helped instil in me during the years I spent around him.

Bro Kwei, I may not have said it enough, and perhaps I never had the opportunity to say it in the way I should have, but **thank you**.

Thank you for opening a door for me when I needed one.

Thank you for paying my school fees.

Thank you for teaching me, directly and indirectly, about prayer, devotion, Scripture and the importance of putting God first.

Thank you for the Sunday mornings, the fresh notes for offering, the quiet times, the Bible recitals, and for **Psalm 1**, which remains one of the clearest spiritual memories I carry from those days.

Thank you for your visits, your generosity, your home, your kindness and the memories.

Thank you for helping to shape the foundation of the man I became.

Your kindness was not forgotten while you were alive, and it will certainly not be forgotten now that you are gone.

> I will carry those memories and that gratitude with me always.
> **Rest peacefully, Bro Kwei.**
> May your soul rest in perfect peace.

Your kindness lives on in the lives you touched, and in mine, your contribution will forever remain part of my story.

Tribute to My Beloved Grandpa, Mr. Daniel Ayitiah

There are some people who come into our lives, and there are others whom God places in our lives for a purpose. For me, Grandpa was one of those people.

I did not meet Grandpa under ordinary circumstances. I first knew him through his school, where I had been employed as an assistant teacher. At that point in my life, teaching was all I knew. I did not see anything beyond it. I did not know what I would become or what my future would look like; I was simply trying to make a living and support my family with the opportunity I had.

One day while having lunch, I was told that Grandpa wanted to see me in his office. It was my very first encounter with him, and honestly, I was scared. I had been told he was a very strict person, so the moment I heard he wanted to see me, I became nervous. I walked into his office not knowing that the conversation we were about to have would change the course of my life forever.

He looked at my secondary school results, looked up at me, and said, "Young man, you have great results. I will not let you be an assistant teacher. You have to go to school."

I tried to explain my situation. I told him about my family and how my father had left my mother during a difficult period, leaving us without support. I explained that this job was my only way to survive. Grandpa listened, but he was unmoved in his decision.

He told me about Ashesi University and encouraged me to apply for a scholarship. He even gave me money to visit Ashesi the very next day, even though it was a working day, and asked me to come back and tell him what I thought. I remember arriving at Ashesi and being completely amazed. I had never seen anything like it before. The campus was beautiful, and I remember thinking that a place like this was only for people who had the means to afford it. I could not imagine someone like me studying there.

When I returned and told Grandpa how beautiful the school was, he asked me, "You like the place?" with a gentle smile.

Standing with my hands behind my back and a big smile on my face, I said yes.

He replied, "Then what you have to do is to prepare yourself to go there."

Those words were simple, but they carried a faith in me that I did not yet have in myself.

When the applications opened, Grandpa invited me to his house to help. He tasked the then headmaster to help me with the essays required, and asked me to bring whatever I came up with to him to inspect and review before submitting. He sat with me for hours, late into the night, helping me work through the essays. Whenever there was a mistake, he would say, "This isn't the best... when you go to Rome, you do what the Romans do!"

When I eventually received admission to Ashesi, Grandpa went even further: he gave me the money to pay the admission costs well before the deadline. He

told me that the best way I could thank him was to graduate with a first class degree.

I remember feeling both sad and excited when he said that. I was sad because, at a point in my life when I longed for a father's love, God had placed someone in my life who believed in me so deeply, but I was excited because I finally had someone behind me rooting for my success someone I could proudly call my Grandpa and that is exactly what he became to me.

He was not simply someone who helped me get into university. He became a father figure, a mentor, a counselor, a source of encouragement, and a man whose words I always looked forward to hearing. As time went on, our conversations evolved. They were no longer only about Ashesi or my education; they became conversations about life, faith, purpose, God, and the future. I loved listening to Grandpa tell his stories. He would share where he started, where God had brought him from, and where he believed God was taking him. He spoke with such conviction. Sometimes I saw the story of Joseph in his life, and he would share how he believed God was still writing his story.

One scripture Grandpa often reminded me of was Exodus 14:22: how the Israelites went into the midst of the sea upon dry ground, with the waters standing like a wall on either side. He would always emphasize the words, "dry ground." He would say, "If God can do that on dry ground for them, then He will take care of you."

Those words stayed with me. Whenever life felt uncertain, Grandpa brought me back to faith. He reminded me that the same God who made a way through the Red Sea was more than able to make a way for me.

That was Grandpa's faith. He believed in God deeply, and he wanted me to believe too. He did not just tell me about God; he used his own life to show me what it meant to trust Him. No matter what he was going through, I always saw hope in him. He was a positive force in my life, and when I think about the person I am today, I cannot tell my story without telling his. I often say that if it were not for Grandpa, I do not know where I would be today. He saw potential in me when I didn't see it in myself. He picked me up from a place where I had very little and helped polish me into someone who could dream again.

Grandpa was one of the three men God used in my life to help me understand and appreciate fatherhood alongside my pastor, Reverend Francis, and my dear

uncle, Uncle Samuel. Grandpa showed me what it meant to have a man believe in you, guide you, and genuinely want to see you succeed.

When I look back, I realize that our relationship was one of God's greatest gifts to me. God knew what I had gone through and placed Grandpa in my life at the exact moment I needed someone to believe in me. His greatest gift to me was not material; it was belief. Because he believed in me, I learned to believe in myself.

Grandpa, thank you for seeing me.

Thank you for believing in me.

Thank you for giving me a chance and helping me discover a future I could not see for myself.

Most of all, thank you for allowing me to experience what it meant to call someone Grandpa and to truly mean it from the depths of my heart. If anyone ever asks what Grandpa meant to me, I may never have enough words to answer them but I will show them through the life I live, the values I carry, and the dreams I pursue.

Rest well, Grandpa. You have fought your fight, you have run your race, and you have left behind a legacy that we who love will carry for the rest of our lives. Until we meet again at the courts of heaven, I will keep becoming the man you believed I could be.

Your grandson, forever grateful.
Samuel Greyham

Family Photographs




OLYMPIA

Daniel Kwei Ayitiah

11 JULY 1950 TO 20 SEPTEMBER 2026

Rest in perfect peace

PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH OF GHANA
CALVARY CONGREGATION, HAATSO.

A legacy that lasts a lifetime